

tered interface in the tradition of Google. In fact unlike MySpace there is no provision to customise your profile. Even though it seems a little monotonous, the eye sometimes yearns for uniformity. In fact Orkut's interface is both its biggest advantage as well as disadvantage. People can be added to your Friend list simply by clicking on Add as Friend tab in their profile, though the request has to be accepted. People can be banned by adding to the Ignore list. Then there is stuff like Fans and Crush list which are great to dabble in when you are tired of twiddling your thumbs.

Members can communicate through scraps: think of it like writing e-mails without having to fill in all those pesky details.

Bad, bad server. No denut for you.

Unfortunately, the orkut.com server has acted out in an unexpected way. Hopefully, it will return to its helpful self if you try again in a few minutes.

It's likely that the server will behave this way on occasion during the coming months. We apologize for the inconvenience and for our server's lack of consideration for others.

Orkut's server giving up its ghost

These scraps are publicly viewable. There is also a privately viewable Message option which is rarely used. People come together in groups which are called Communities. Each Community has an owner, and may have a moderator and are grouped by common interest. Polls were introduced in 2007 for every community. Apart from polls Google has introduced a slew of new features. The Profile Album was there from the start; you could upload maximum of 12 photos with captions optional, now with Google acquiring YouTube, it has become possible to upload videos from YouTube or Google video by attaching the link. The video plays inline. Google Talk can be launched from within Orkut and the online status of your Google Talk's contacts can be known real time, if both they and you have signed in using Google accounts. Profile views since Feb '06 (the numbers tends to massage your ego) as well as the names of five most recent profile visitors are displayed. Two brand new features, RSS feeds for your blogs as well as Orkut's very own blog open to all users is going to warm the cockles of the hearts of avid bloggers.